Tran Le

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Education

Cornell University **Ithaca, NY**
B.A. Information Science (Honors) & Psychology (Honors) 2023–2027
Concentrations: Behavioral Science, User Experience, Cognition

- **Cumulative GPA:** 4.223/4.3
- **Advisors:** Dr. Susan Fussell (Information Science), Dr. Charles Brainerd (Psychology)

Honors & Awards

CRA Outstanding Undergraduate Researcher Award (Cornell Nominee) 2026
Selected as one of 2-4 undergraduates nominated by Cornell Information Science for the national round.

Cornell Power of Experience Grant ($1,500) 2026
Awarded travel funding to present first-authored research at two NeurIPS workshops.

Cornell Summer Experience Grant ($3,500) 2026
Awarded for the research internship at the Gopnik Cognitive Development and Learning Lab, UC Berkeley.

Cornell Psychology Summer Undergraduate Research Funding (SURF) ($1,320) 2026
Awarded to support an independent Psychology honors thesis.

Tapia Conference on Technology and Computing Travel Award ($1,500) 2026
Selected as 1 of 2 undergraduate award recipients funded by Cornell's Department of Information Science.

Phi Beta Kappa (Vice President) 2026
Elected as a junior; top 3% of Cornell College of Arts and Sciences class.

Cornell Combined Scholarship Package ($98,529 annually) 2023–present
Awarded Foreign Students Scholarship, Sugita Family Scholarship, and S. H. Baik Family Scholarship.

Papers & Posters

[P1] "Who's Doing the Reviewing? Tracing AI Delegation in Scientific Peer Review" [link]
Tran Le, Eunice Yiu
Accepted at AI-Native Academia and AI & Science - Evolution or Extinction? @ NeurIPS 2026
Submitted to CHI 2027

[P2] "Semantic Attribute Perception in Large Language Models" [link]
Ben Chen, Isabella Cranshaw, **Tran Le**, Olivia Qin, Bianca Thompson, Owen Yan, Xinya Liu, Charles J. Brainerd
Presented at Cornell Undergraduate Psychology Conference 2026

Research Experience

Cognitive Development and Learning Lab (PI: Professor Alison Gopnik) **Berkeley, CA**
Research Assistant, Summer Research Intern Jun–Sep 2026
(Selected as 1 of 7 students from 400+ applicants)

1. Independent Project: Who's Doing the Reviewing? Tracing AI Delegation in Scientific Peer Review [P1]

- Recruited 100+ researchers to study how they consult and incorporate AI when reading manuscripts and forming peer-review judgments, and how these behaviors relate to review diversity and their ability to substantiate claims.
- Built a Node/Express study platform using Google Cloud Storage/Firestore and backend API calls to trace paper navigation, AI interactions, keystrokes, revisions, copy-paste provenance, and post-review evidence localization.
- Coded AI queries and adoption patterns; quantified post-paste editing via Levenshtein distance; analyzed lexical, semantic, and perspective similarity; compared findings with ICLR peer reviews to assess ecological validity.
- Trained two undergraduate coders to evaluate evidence grounding through ratings of evidentiary support and selection precision.

2. When Do Children Delegate Inquiry to AI? Measuring Developmental Reliance

- Examined (1) children's help-seeking preferences across informational, emotional, and social contexts, and (2) their allocation of causal inquiry among self-exploration, AI-provided evidence, and AI-provided solutions.
- Administered 23 testing sessions with children aged 6–12 in person at museums and remotely through Children Helping Science using a blicket-machine causal-learning paradigm.

Memory and Neuroscience Lab (PI: Professor Charles Brainerd) **Ithaca, NY**
Honors Student, Research Assistant Aug 2025–present

1. Honors Thesis: Cognitive Offloading and Deep Distortions in Episodic and Semantic Memory

- Investigate whether cognitive offloading amplifies deep memory distortions – patterns of judgments about the same item or event that collectively violate logical or probabilistic principles – across memory systems.
- Develop episodic- and semantic-memory experiments using the Deese–Roediger–McDermott (DRM) and Distortions in Everyday Memory (DEM) paradigms with offloading manipulations and conjoint recognition.
- Build custom Qualtrics interfaces that simulate two offloading contexts: external storage through saved word lists and retrieval/verification support through simulated Google AI Overviews.
- Develop an analysis plan using multinomial processing tree models to estimate verbatim, gist, and response bias parameters from true/false recognition and test offloading effects via equality constrained model comparisons.

2. General Lab Projects

- Collect semantic attribute ratings for 2,000+ items across multiple LLMs [P2] and clean data from an episodic-memory study of probability violations in recognition and source-memory judgments.
- Implement Qualtrics surveys and proctor 45 false-recognition reversal, memory-framing, paired-similarity, eyewitness deep-distortion, and false-memory experiments.

Communication and Collaborative Technologies Lab (PI: Professor Susan Fussell) **Ithaca, NY**
Honors Student, Research Assistant Feb 2025–present

1. Independent Project: Language of Interaction in AI-Assisted Ideation

- Lead a 6-person undergraduate and master's research team to investigate how multilingual, non-native English-speaking students use generative AI for ideation across their native language (L1) and English.
- Design a counterbalanced within-subject study comparing L1 and English chatbot-assisted brainstorming and outlining, with counterbalanced language order and problem-solution writing prompts.
- Deploy a custom platform with a self-hosted Gemma-powered multilingual chatbot via Ollama, an outline editor, Node/Express backend, SQLite interaction logging, and post-task ratings and language-profile questionnaires.
- Analyze perceived experience across cognitive, evaluative, prompting, and agency dimensions and the extent of its alignment with students' usual AI language and usual preferred languages for thinking processes in R.

2. XPLAIN: Proactivity in Scaffolding Comprehension and Production in Real-Time Turn-Taking

- Develop XPLAIN, a video-conferencing AI assistant that supports shared grounding through proactive, real-time content prediction and generation tailored to users' languages, domain knowledge, and communication needs.
- Design conversational scenarios; clarifications, suggestions, summaries, language-switching features; Figma flows; bilingual-history and domain-familiarity surveys; and native-language, English, and bilingual support formats.
- Manage scheduling; administer 27 user study sessions; code disfluency, gaze, and interaction data from 38 video recordings; thematically analyze interview transcripts in ATLAS.ti; analyze survey and behavioral data in R.
- Compare AI disfluency labels with ground truth; calculate inter-rater reliability; author coding schemes and audit guides defining acoustic, timing, semantic, and syntactic boundary rules across disfluency categories.

NSF I-Corps Regional Course

- Accepted into a 3-week intensive program applying business model canvas, value proposition testing, customer archetypes, and pivoting frameworks to explore and improve XPLAIN's real-world applications.
- Conduct 30 interviews with patients, doctors, therapists, insurance staff, and refugee-services staff to refine XPLAIN's customer segment, beachhead use case, and adoption barriers around insurance and care navigation.

Research Project with Professor Allison Koenecke & Dr. Anaïs Rameau **Ithaca, NY**
Research Assistant Jul 2025–May 2026

- Transcribed ∼1,000 dysphonic speech recordings in Praat to produce ground-truth data for evaluating the performance of commercial automated speech recognition (ASR) systems on medically impaired speech.
- Collaborated with Weill Cornell Medicine and adhered to HIPAA-compliant data management workflows.

Cornell Phonetics Lab (PI: Professor Samuel Tilsen) **Ithaca, NY**
Research Assistant Aug–Dec 2024

- Studied how random, constrained interactions shape the emergence of dialects across networks of speakers.
- Reviewed Whisper-generated transcripts, created ground-truth Praat TextGrid files, and parsed, analyzed, and visualized TextGrid annotations in R to examine phonetic, lexical, and conversational trends and patterns.

Research Project with Professor Shimon Edelman **Ithaca, NY**
Research Assistant Dec 2023–Dec 2024

- Examined turn-taking timing variations in bilingual, autistic, Down syndrome, and typically developing children through conversational factors such as pause length, utterance initiation speed, and conversational flow.
- Annotated 133 naturalistic caregiver-child conversations (children aged 15–25 months) in ELAN, coding speech onsets and offsets for turn-transition latency analyses and calculating reliability with ICC and Cohen's kappa.
- Conducted literature reviews on turn-taking, attention, pragmatics, joint engagement, and computational frameworks, and trained 3 new lab members on coding protocols and literature review workflows.

Hackathons

CMD-IT Tapia GenAI Student Hackathon **Atlanta, GA**
Winner ($100) Sep 2026

- Designed a multi-agent fact-checker that extracts and classifies factual claims from online essays, verifies claims against outside sources, and generates reports annotated with claim-level verdicts and confidence scores.
- Used Python, OpenRouter, OpenAI SDK, Claude Sonnet, Qwen2.5 via Ollama, BeautifulSoup, and Dux Distributed Global Search.

Internship Experience

Clinical Psychology Unit (University Medical Center HCMC) **Vietnam**
Intern Jun–July 2024

- Shadowed 65 psychiatrist-led counseling sessions for patients with neurodevelopmental, anxiety, depressive, and trauma-related disorders, observing cognitive behavioral, dialectical behavior, and relaxation therapies.
- Wrote case reports summarizing patient histories and practicing multimodal therapy (BASIC I.D.) case conceptualization, DSM-V diagnostic reasoning, and intervention planning under psychiatrist mentorship.

Teaching Experience

INFO 4505: Computing and Global Development **Ithaca, NY**
Teaching Assistant Aug 2026–present

- Mentor 5 project teams applying Information and Communication Technologies and Development (ICTD) and human-centered design frameworks to underserved-community projects.
- Design AI-resistant assignments, create reading quizzes, hold office hours, support Canvas/Slack communication, and grade activities, project presentations, milestones, and deliverables for 130+ students.

INFO 2310: Interactive Web Application Design and Development **Ithaca, NY**
Teaching Assistant Jan–May 2026

- Graded assignments and exams and led weekly practice problem workshops for 40+ students on JavaScript, React, client-server architecture, REST APIs, MongoDB, Express, and HTTP communication.

INFO 1300: Introductory Design and Programming for the Web **Ithaca, NY**
Teaching Assistant Aug–Dec 2025

- Supported 50+ students in learning HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and user-centered design by proctoring weekly quizzes, reviewing solutions, holding weekly office hours, and grading assignments.

CS 1110: Introduction to Computing: A Design and Development Perspective **Ithaca, NY**
Course Consultant Jan–May 2025

- Supported 40+ students through biweekly lab sections, weekly consulting hours, debugging help, exam preparation, and detailed grading feedback on Python assignments and exams.

Activities

Women in Computing at Cornell (WICC) **Ithaca, NY**
Faculty Relations Director Jan–Dec 2025

- Organized the Lunch Bunch program, facilitating weekly roundtable discussions that connected 70+ underclasswomen with computing faculty and promoted research opportunities.
- Represented WICC and the computing student body at semesterly faculty board meetings, synthesizing feedback from 200+ students on coursework, workload, advising, and office hours to inform departmental improvements.

Cornell's Translator Interpreter Program (TIP) **Ithaca, NY**
Volunteer Dec 2024–May 2026

- Translated and interpreted for organizations serving immigrants with limited English proficiency.
- Reviewed and corrected workplace performance document translations, provided live interpretation during parent meetings, and translated institutional materials (e.g., employee health benefits).

Cornell Undergraduate Research Board (CURB) **Ithaca, NY**
Peer Mentor Oct–Dec 2024

- Led weekly group discussions and one-on-one check-ins to advise 7 students on professor outreach, lab selection, application strategies, and basic research skills.

Professional Membership: Information Science Student Association (Member) | Psi Chi (Member)

Skills & Tools

- **Programming & Data Analysis:** R, Python, JavaScript, SQL
- **Web & Application Development:** React, Node.js, Express.js, MongoDB, Git, HTML, CSS
- **Research & Design:** Figma, Qualtrics, Google Cloud Storage/Firestore, SONA, ATLAS.ti, Praat, ELAN
- **Documentation & Presentation:** LaTeX, R Markdown, Canva, Microsoft Office, Google Suites
- **UX & User Research:** Contextual Interviews, Customer Discovery, Stakeholder Mapping, User Archetypes, Affinity Diagramming, Competitive Analysis, Scenario Mapping, Storyboard Sketching, Design Systems, Interaction Design, Visual Design, Prototyping, Heuristic Evaluations, Usability Testing
- **Language:** English (proficient), Vietnamese (native)